

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Struggling to close clients without a portfolio?

Here is the loop you are in. And three ways out.

03



@csos

Swipe →

THE PORTFOLIO LOOP

BLOCK 1

**Cannot get clients
without a portfolio.**

BLOCK 2

**Cannot build a
portfolio without
clients.**

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE DAY TO DAY

It gets hard to sit at the desk.

Outreach stops feeling exciting. The niche you picked two months ago gets swapped for a new one.

Nothing ships.

A PORTFOLIO IS NOT HOW YOU ESCAPE

The prospect does not read portfolios the way people think they do.

What they read is a piece of thinking about their own business.

That, you can write today.

ROUTE ONE. PUBLIC TEARDOWN

One ad, broken down. Every week.

Screenshot. Three sentences. What you see.
What you would test next. What you expect.

Eight weeks, eight posts, a body of visible thinking.

01

ROUTE TWO. STRATEGY DOCUMENT

One page. Sent first.

Pick five businesses. Write one page each. Who the offer is for. Why it is selling. What you would do next.

Send it without a rate and without a services page.

02

ROUTE THREE. SPEC WORK

Write the creative strategy you wish the brand had.

Pick three brands. Publish the piece with your name on it.

Slower. More polished.

03

PICK THE ONE YOU WILL ACTUALLY FINISH

The creative strategists who stay stuck are the ones who pick all three and finish none.

Pick one. Send or publish inside two weeks. Start a second the day after.

THE TRUTH

The portfolio was never the blocker.

The blocker was not sending the thinking.

Send it.

NEXT STEP

Not sure which route fits where you are?

Take the 5-minute creative strategy quiz.

→ creativestrategyos.com/quiz